ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

Exam Preparation and Revision: A Four-Week Plan That Holds Up

Plan, practise and manage exam-day pressure without last-minute panic

STUDY SKILLS

Study Skills

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Study smarter. Ask better questions. Pass with understanding.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

This pack gives you a four-week revision architecture, a way to prioritise courses by risk and weight, and exam-hall technique for multiple-choice, theory and calculation papers. It also covers the practical side: materials, timing and the night before.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Build a four-week revision plan prioritised by course risk.
- Use spaced testing instead of rereading slides.
- Apply paper-specific exam technique for objective, theory and calculation questions.
- Manage exam anxiety and the 24 hours before a paper.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Prioritise before you plan

Not every course deserves equal time. Rank them by consequence and current weakness.

- List every course with its credit unit and exam date.
- Rate your current confidence from one to five with evidence, not feeling.
- Compute a simple priority score: credit units times the gap between confidence and five.
- Give the highest scores more blocks, but never abandon a course entirely.
- Protect the courses with early exam dates from being crowded out.
- Put the plan on paper where you can see it daily.

The four-week architecture

Spread the work so the final week is consolidation, not first-time learning.

1. Week four before: skim all syllabi, gather materials, write topic checklists.
2. Week three: cover the weakest high-priority topics, one past question per course.
3. Week two: active recall across all courses, timed sections, fix repeated errors.
4. Week one: full past papers under exam conditions, then targeted repair only.
5. Each day: two or three courses maximum, alternating heavy and lighter subjects.
6. Last 48 hours: review summaries, formula sheets and error logs. No new topics.

> **Test, do not reread**
> Rereading creates familiarity. Closing the book and writing from memory creates the retrieval skill the exam actually requires.

In the hall

Exam technique is worth marks independent of knowledge.

- Read all instructions and check the number of questions and sections.
- Budget time per question and keep a few minutes for review.
- Answer the easiest questions first to secure marks and settle nerves.
- For objective questions, answer every item unless there is a penalty for guessing.
- For theory, define terms, structure with paragraphs and use examples.
- For calculations, show method, units and a final statement. Box your answer.

> **If you blank**
> Write the question in your own words, list what you know about the topic and start with the definition. Motion usually returns recall.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Why is a confidence rating with evidence better than a feeling?

Answer: Evidence such as past-question scores prevents overconfidence and targets study where marks are actually at risk.

2. What should the last 48 hours before an exam contain?

Answer: Review of summaries, formula sheets and an error log. No new topics and no all-night cramming.

3. How should you use a past paper?

Answer: First as a timed diagnostic under exam conditions, then as a source of an error log that drives targeted repair.

4. Give two exam-hall strategies for theory papers.

Answer: Plan a brief outline before writing, and define key terms early with a concrete example.

5. Why is it risky to study only one course for days?

Answer: Other courses decay through disuse, and the schedule may not leave time to recover them.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] List every course with credit units and exam dates.
- [ ] Rate your confidence with evidence from a past question.
- [ ] Build the four-week plan on paper.
- [ ] Complete one timed past paper per course.
- [ ] Start an error log and update it after each practice.
- [ ] Prepare a one-page formula and definition sheet per course.
- [ ] Rehearse exam-day logistics: venue, time, materials and transport.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date: